

AP
2
B605

THE BLACK PANTHER

INTERCOMMUNAL NEWS SERVICE

PUBLISHED WEEKLY BY THE BLACK PANTHER PARTY

copyright © 1977 by Huey P. Newton

VOL. XVII NO. 24

SATURDAY, DECEMBER 3, 1977

25¢



Constitutional Guarantees Undermined

F.B.I. COINTELPRO FILES—"RIGHT TO DISSENT" UNDER ATTACK

ALDERMAN LIBRARY

DEC 12 1977

UNIV. OF VIRGINIA
CHARLOTTESVILLE, VA

(Washington, D.C.) - The "right to dissent" has long been portrayed as a cherished privilege of the American people guaranteed under the U.S. Constitution. Yet, according to close to 53,000 heavily-censored pages of documents released last week by the Federal Bureau of Investigation, all too often those who bravely practiced this "right" were harassed by federal police surveillance and/or victimized by other forms of illegal domestic intelligence abuses.

Such is the sordid, 15-year history of the FBI's infamous COINTELPRO (Counterintelligence Program), whose undercover operations systematically and deliberately violated Constitutional guarantees in a vain "dirty tricks" effort to purge America of valuable political dissenting opinion.

As the 52,648 pages released last week under the Freedom of Information Act indicate, the COINTELPRO program was initiated in 1956 by then FBI Director J. Edgar Hoover to illegally infiltrate and curtail the activities of the Communist Party in the United States. From that beginning until Hoover, without notice or explanation, defused the program in an April 28, 1971, memo, COINTELPRO grew to become an all-encompassing federal police attack against Black,



In the 15-year history of the FBI's COINTELPRO program Black, Chicano, Puerto Rican and Native American activists have been prime targets in an effort to destroy the movement for progressive change in the U.S.

Chicano, Native American, Puerto Rican and other minority rights activists, the anti-war movement and the progressive left sector of the American people.

From 1967 to 1971 for example, the Black Panther Party was targeted for 233 of 295 COINTELPRO operations enacted against

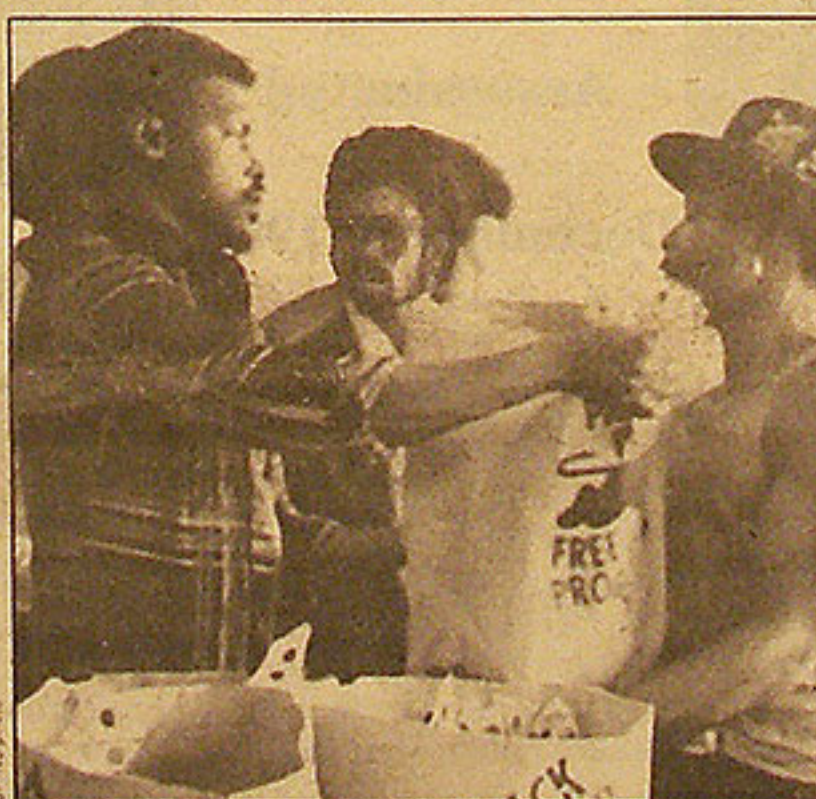
11-Month Campaign Continues

L.A.P.D. HARASSMENT OF B.P.P. DETAILED

(Los Angeles, Calif.) - Since the reopening of the Southern California Chapter of the Black Panther Party 11 months ago, the notorious Los Angeles Police Department (LAPD) has continually attempted to harass and intimidate Party members and to obstruct Party activities.

In this year alone, the LAPD has been responsible for the deaths of over 30 people, many of whom have been murdered in cold blood. Los Angeles police, headed by the ultra-reactionary chief Ed Davis, have gained a reputation for their brutal treatment of Black and poor people.

Police repression in Los Angeles against the Black Panther Party has been as vicious as anywhere in the country, evidenced by the numerous unjust beatings, jailings, arrests and murders of Party members. An example of this treachery is the murder of Steve Bartholomew, Tommy Lewis and Robert Lawrence on August



Free groceries are distributed by BPP Free Food Program in Los Angeles.

25, 1968. The three BPP members had parked in a gas station when members of the LAPD's metro squad opened fire, killing them almost instantly.

On December 8, 1969, four days after the murder of Party leaders Fred Hampton and Mark Clark in Chicago, 500 police officers, led by the LAPD's infamous SWAT team, laid siege to the Southern California BPP Chapter's headquarters for over eight hours — while simultaneously 18 Party members were arrested throughout Los Angeles.

The Southern California Chapter of the Black Panther Party reopened on January 17, 1977, — eight years after Fallen Comrades Alprentice "Bunchy" Carter and John Huggins were murdered by members of the reactionary US organization while organizing Black students on the UCLA campus.

Since January 17 of this year the Southern

CENTRAL DISTRIBUTION
8501 E. 14TH STREET
OAKLAND, CALIF. 94621